
New Cat Parent Guide



Everything you need for a happy, confident
start together — from shopping lists to
first-week wisdom, the Georgie way.

Before Georgie Arrives

The welcome-home shopping list



The essentials

- ☐ Food + water bowls (wide & shallow)
- ☐ Quality cat food (kitten or adult)
- ☐ Litter box — at least 1.5x your cat's body length, one per cat plus one extra
- ☐ Unscented litter + scoop
- ☐ Sturdy scratching post
- ☐ Cozy bed (a box works too!)
- ☐ Carrier for safe travel

The happy extras

- ☐ Wand toy + solo toys
- ☐ Brush or grooming glove
- ☐ Nail clippers (cat-sized)
- ☐ Cat tree or window perch
- ☐ Treats for bonding & training
- ☐ Puzzle feeder for clever cats
- ☐ A blanket that smells like home

Georgie's tip

Set everything up before your cat comes home, then let them explore at their own pace. A quiet "base camp" room makes the first days much easier.



The First Week



Slow and gentle wins every heart

DAYS
1-2

The safe room

Keep your cat in one quiet room with food, water, litter, and hiding spots. Sit nearby, talk softly, and let them come to you — don't force interaction. It's totally normal for a new cat to hide or skip a meal at first — don't panic, just keep checking in gently.

DAYS
3-4

Little hellos

Offer treats and gentle play. Slow blinks are cat kisses — try returning them! Short, calm visits beat long ones. Use a feather wand instead of your hands for play — it keeps tiny claws and teeth associated with toys, not fingers.

DAYS
5-7

Exploring home

Open the door and let them explore at their own speed. Keep routines steady: same feeding times, same litter spot. Expect a few sudden bursts of running ("zoomies") as confidence grows — it's a great sign they're settling in.

WEEK
2+

Building trust

Start a daily play ritual, introduce family members one at a time, and book a friendly first vet check-up. Leave the carrier out with a soft blanket inside so it becomes a familiar napping spot, not something scary.



Feeding Basics

Happy tummies, healthy bodies



How much & how often

- 🐾 Kittens (under 6 months): 3–4 small meals a day
- 🐾 Adults: 2 meals a day at regular times
- 🐾 Fresh water always — many cats love a fountain
- 🐾 A quality commercial cat food (wet, dry, or a mix) should be the actual diet — cats need nutrients like taurine that only a complete cat food reliably provides
- 🐾 Portion size: check the feeding chart on your food's packaging (it's based on calorie density, which varies by brand) — as a rough starting point, a typical adult cat eats about 1/4 to 1/3 cup of dry food a day, split into 2 meals
- 🐾 Switch foods gradually over 7–10 days to avoid tummy upsets

Treats (a few times a week, not daily)

- 🐾 Small pieces of plain cooked chicken or turkey (no skin, bones, or seasoning)
- 🐾 A small amount of cooked fish like salmon (occasional — too much can cause a thiamine deficiency)
- 🐾 Commercial cat treats: no more than about 10% of daily calories

Never feed your cat

- 🐾 Onions, garlic, chives & leeks
- 🐾 Chocolate, coffee & anything caffeinated
- 🐾 Grapes & raisins
- 🐾 Alcohol & raw dough
- 🐾 Xylitol (in sugar-free gum & candy)
- 🐾 Cooked bones & excessive raw fish
- 🐾 Dog food as a diet — cats need their own nutrients

If something risky gets eaten

Call your vet or the ASPCA Animal Poison Control Center right away:

(888) 426-4435 — available 24/7



A Cat-Safe Home

Curiosity-proofing 101



Plants to keep far away

- 🐾 Lilies — extremely dangerous, even the pollen or vase water
- 🐾 Sago palm, tulips, daffodils & hyacinths (especially bulbs)
- 🐾 Pothos, philodendron, dieffenbachia & peace lily
- 🐾 Azalea, oleander & cyclamen

Safe greenery instead

- 🐾 Cat grass & catnip
- 🐾 Spider plant
- 🐾 Boston fern
- 🐾 Areca palm
- 🐾 Parlor palm
- 🐾 Calathea (prayer plant)

Around the house

- 🐾 Tuck away cords, hair ties, ribbons & strings — favorite snacks, sadly
- 🐾 Keep medications, cleaners & essential oils behind closed doors
- 🐾 Check the dryer and closets before closing — cats love warm caves
- 🐾 Secure window screens; a high perch is fine, a loose screen is not
- 🐾 Breakables love shelves. Cats love shelves more. Plan accordingly!



Cleaning & Care



A simple rhythm keeps everyone healthy

Every day

- 🐾 Scoop the litter box at least once (twice is even better)
- 🐾 Wash food & water bowls, or refill with fresh water

Every week

- 🐾 Full litter change + wash the box with mild, unscented soap (skip bleach and harsh chemicals)
- 🐾 Wash bedding and any cloth toys
- 🐾 Brush a short-haired cat at least once — daily for long-haired cats to prevent mats

Every month

- 🐾 Wipe down the scratching post and shake out any trapped litter or fur
- 🐾 Deep-clean feeding mats and toy baskets

Good to know

- 🐾 Nail trims: every 2-4 weeks, or as needed
- 🐾 Replace the litter box entirely every 1-2 years — plastic absorbs odor over time no matter how well it's cleaned

Allergic to cats? Worth knowing about

All cats produce Fel d 1, an allergen in their saliva that transfers onto fur and dander during grooming — the actual trigger behind most human cat allergies. Purina ONE LiveClear uses an egg-sourced protein that binds to and neutralizes Fel d 1 in a cat's mouth. In Purina's research, cats fed it daily showed about a 47% average drop in active Fel d 1 by the 3rd week. Results vary cat to cat and it's not a guaranteed fix, but it's a real, science-backed option worth asking your vet about.



Health & Vet Care

A little routine goes a long way



The usual schedule

- 🐾 First check-up within the first week or two of coming home
- 🐾 Kittens: vaccine visits about every 3–4 weeks until ~16 weeks old
- 🐾 Adults: a wellness visit once a year
- 🐾 Seniors (7+ years): twice-yearly check-ups are ideal
- 🐾 Ask your vet about spay/neuter, microchipping & parasite prevention

Call the vet if you notice

- ♥ Not eating or drinking for 24 hours
- ♥ Repeated vomiting or diarrhea
- ♥ Straining in the litter box or going outside it suddenly
- ♥ Hiding much more than usual, or sudden behavior changes
- ♥ Coughing, labored breathing, limping, or crying when touched

My cat's vet info

Clinic: _____

Phone: _____

Emergency clinic: _____

Phone: _____



Cool Cat Facts

A little trivia to impress your friends



1

A cat's nose print is completely unique, just like a human fingerprint.

2

Cats can't taste sweetness — they're missing the taste receptor gene for it entirely.

3

Whiskers aren't just cute — they help a cat judge whether a gap is wide enough to fit through.

4

Domestic cats share about 95% of their DNA with tigers.

5

A cat's purr vibrates at a frequency (25-150 Hz) that's been linked to promoting bone and tissue healing.

6

Cats have a third eyelid, called a haw, that's usually only visible when they're very relaxed or unwell.

7

It's normal for a healthy adult cat to sleep 12-16 hours a day.

8

A group of cats is called a 'clowder,' and a group of kittens is a 'kindle.'

9

A cat's hearing range extends up to about 85 kHz — far beyond a dog's roughly 45 kHz and well past a human's 20 kHz.

10

When a cat rubs its cheek or head against you, it's marking you with its own scent — a trust-and-affection behavior called 'bunting.'

